might call camera-friendly. I was self-conscious about using make-up and insisted on being natural, with nothing on my face and nothing done to my hair. It was only later that I realized that it was just a normal part of working with cameras. Later in my career, I really enjoyed shooting commercials and there were some incidents that I can never forget.

On one occasion I was at a shoot with one of India's greatest cinema icons, Amitabh Bachchan, in the Rajasthan city of Jodhpur. While we were taking a break, I suddenly realized that Arjun, who was only a toddler then, had finished his meal and was happily wiping his hands on Amitabh Bachchan's churidar (the lower garment we wear in India with a kurta). Anjali and I were both mortified, but he kindly kept telling us that it was perfectly all right and that a child of Arjun's age hardly knew what he was doing. While Mr Bachchan was looking at the funnier side of the incident, as parents we were extremely embarrassed by it. I even said to him that '*Arjun jabh bada ho jayega to es incident ko yaad karke sharmaega*.' (When Arjun grows up he will remember what he did and feel seriously embarrassed.) His conduct during this episode only added to my respect for the great man.

Another commercial I have fond memories of involved another Bollywood legend, Shahrukh Khan. Shahrukh and I were shooting for Pepsi at Lord's on the eve of the 1999 World Cup and the plan was for Shahrukh to pose as me and open the refrigerator in the dressing room to take out a chilled Pepsi. That's when I was supposed to confront him for impersonating me. I ended up adding my own ideas to the commercial and said we should not stop there, but I should take the Pepsi bottle from him and force him to go out and bat in my place as well. The director loved the idea and the script was changed on the day.

Sri Lanka don't make it easy

Before the first Test of the three-match series started in Ahmedabad on 16 November, Anjali had planned something special for me, to mark my twenty years in international cricket. As a surprise, she and a few of my closest friends hired a private jet and flew into Ahmedabad on the morning of the game. I was having breakfast with MS Dhoni and had my back to the restaurant door when I saw in Dhoni's eyes that something was going on behind me. Even before I could turn to see what was